GITHUB · API KEY

API KEY ON GITHUB?

What happens when your .env file ends up in a public repo.

Swipe →

THE RISK



ANYONE CAN *SEE IT.*

If the repo is public, anyone can open your **.env** file and copy the API key.

PUSH PROTECTION



ONLY PARTLY SAFE.

On public repos, GitHub **blocks the push by default** when it spots a known key. But it can be let through, and it doesn't recognize every key.

GitHub Blog · Feb 29, 2024

COMMIT HISTORY



DELETED IT?

STILL THERE.

If you just delete the file in a new commit, the key stays **in earlier commits, forks and clones**.

GitHub Docs · Removing sensitive data

WHAT TO DO



STEP ONE:

NEW KEY.

According to GitHub, first **revoke the key and get a new one**. Then add .env to .gitignore, and put the key in your host's environment variables.

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BUILT YOUR APP WITH AI?

WANT ME TO *TAKE A LOOK?*

Send me a message.